SOCCER · GIRLS AND WOMEN · GRADES 9 TO 12 · SPORT PLAYBOOK

WOMEN'S SOCCER: THE WHOLE ROAD TO COLLEGE

What to do, when to do it, who pays, and what a coach is and is not allowed to tell you. Built from the 2026-27 NCAA rule text, the printed Division I recruiting calendar, the NAIA and junior college rule books, and the women's pro league labor contract for 2024 to 2030.

VERSION	RULES CHECKED	LEVELS COVERED
2026-27 · sample player: class of 2029	11 November 2026, against the NCAA rule text, the printed Division I calendar, the NAIA handbook and the NJCAA procedures chart	D1 · D2 · D3 · NAIA · junior college

> About 393,000 girls play high school soccer and 31,200 play it in the NCAA, which is 7.9 percent, and 2.8 percent reach Division I. In this sport four dead periods decide when a coach may watch at all, and a change that took effect on 1 July 2025 decides what a scholarship even means. Both are free to know before a family pays $299 for a showcase.

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This book teaches. It is not legal advice, and it does not speak for any school. It promises no roster spot, no playing time, no place at a college, and no money. The NCAA Eligibility Center makes the final call on her record, and each school sets its own aid. Dates marked PROJECTED are worked out from rule text. Nobody has printed them yet. Chapter 3 lists every one.

1. READ THIS FIRST

Read Chapter 2 before you spend any money. Then put the plan in Chapter 3 on one page and cross items off. The rest is for looking things up: what a coach may do, what to send, what the papers mean, and what it all costs.

THE MAIN IDEA

Three things shape this sport, and all three are free to know. The team limit changed on 1 July 2025. The NCAA prints four dead periods, and they set when a Division I coach may watch your daughter. And the rule book sets the first day a coach may write to her, meet her, or host her. A family that knows these dates buys less and wastes less.

Every rule in this book says where it is written. Every number names its document. All of it was read on 11 November 2026, unless a line gives another date. Where this book could not settle a point, Chapter 11 says so.

FOUR RULES THAT SURPRISE FAMILIES

- **A Division I coach may not take her call yet.** Before 15 June after her sophomore year, a Division I coach may not call, text or email her. The coach may not pick up when she calls, either. The one thing allowed is a short reply that does not recruit her. For the class of 2029 that day is 15 June 2027. This book worked that date out from the rule. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.1.3.2.5, 13.4.1 and 13.4.1.13.
- **"28 scholarships" is not the rule.** Since 1 July 2025 the number 28 is a roster limit at Division I schools that are part of a court settlement. It caps players. It does not promise money to any of them. The old limit was 14 scholarship equivalencies. Chapter 2 tells both stories. The 28 is in Division I Manual, Bylaw 17.2. The old 14 is in the College Sports Commission table.
- **The first visit day can land in a dead period.** The rule opens Division I visits on 1 August of junior year. In 2026 that day sat inside a dead period for women's soccer. The first day a coach could meet a girl in person was 12 August. Phone and text stayed open. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.6.2.1.1, and the printed 2026-27 calendar.
- **There is no National Letter of Intent now.** The paper is the school's own offer of aid, in writing. Soccer signs from the second Wednesday in November of senior year, and there is no February date. For her that day works out to 8 November 2028. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.02.13 and 13.9.3.

IF YOU ALSO OWN THE MEN'S SOCCER BOOK

Four things are the same in both books: the contact dates, the visit rules, the 28-player limit and the signing date. Six things differ. The calendars differ: women have four dead periods, and men have two dead periods and one quiet period. The old Division I limit was 14 for women and 9.9 for men. Division II is 9.9 for women and 9.0 for men. The odds differ: 7.9 percent of high school girls reach an NCAA team, and 5.9 percent of boys do. The women's first game date is earlier: 12 August 2026, against 27 August 2026. And after college, the top women's league has no draft.

Read 11 November 2026. The Division I recruiting calendar for 2026-27. The College Sports Commission table of old and new limits. Division II Manual, Bylaws 15.4.2.1.1 and 15.4.2.1.2. The NCAA Research odds table, updated March 2026. Division I Manual, Figure 17-2. The women's league labor contract, Section 13.8.

WORDS THIS BOOK USES

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
EQUIVALENCY	One full scholarship's worth of money. A coach may cut it into pieces. Division II has 9.9 of them per team. Half a scholarship counts as 0.5.
ROSTER LIMIT	A cap on players, not on money. It is 28 in Division I women's soccer at a settlement school.
SETTLEMENT SCHOOL	A Division I school in a defendant conference, or one that opted in to the House settlement. House is the name of a court case. A defendant conference is one that was sued in it. This book uses the short name for both kinds.
DEAD PERIOD	Days when a Division I coach may not meet her or watch her, on campus or off. No visit of either kind may happen. Calls and texts are still allowed. Bylaw 13.02.5.5.
QUIET PERIOD	Days when a coach may meet her only on the college campus. No watching or meeting away from campus. Bylaw 13.02.5.4.
EVALUATION PERIOD	Days when a coach may watch her away from campus but may not talk with her there. Bylaw 13.02.5.2.
RECRUITING SHUTDOWN	Days when no recruiting of any kind is allowed, not even a call. Bylaw 13.02.5.6.
CONTACT	A face-to-face talk that goes past hello.
EVALUATION	A coach watching her play, or checking her grades, away from campus.
OFFICIAL VISIT	A campus visit the school pays for.
UNOFFICIAL VISIT	A campus visit the family pays for.
ELIGIBILITY CENTER	The NCAA office that checks her school record and clears her to play. The NAIA has its own.
CORE COURSE	A high school class the NCAA has approved. Division I and Division II each ask for 16 of them.
AID AGREEMENT	The school's offer of athletics aid, in writing. It took the place of the National Letter of Intent.
COST OF ATTENDANCE	The school's own figure for one year there. One Division I player's aid may not go above it. Bylaw 15.1.
HARD	A date that a named document prints.
PROJECTED	A date this book worked out from rule text. Nobody has printed it yet, so it can move. Chapter 3 tags every one.
SERVICE	A price or number from a company's own page, not from a rule book.

2. HOW MANY PLAYERS A TEAM CAN TAKE

This chapter sets how long her list should be and what an offer can mean. It starts with one date, 1 July 2025. Before that date the Division I rule was about money. After it, at settlement schools, the rule is about people.

THE DIVISION I TEAM LIMIT, TOLD TWICE

The old rule, before 1 July 2025. A Division I women's soccer team could give 14 scholarship equivalencies. An equivalency is one full scholarship's worth of money. A coach could cut the 14 into pieces and spread them across the team.

The new rule, from 1 July 2025. At a settlement school the limit is 28 players on the roster. The NCAA sets no aid cap for that team. The school decides how much of the roster gets money. It may give full or part scholarships to all 28. It does not have to pay for any spot.

When the limit starts. The 28 limit starts the day after the roster is due. Before that day a team may carry more players in preseason. Ask how many names will be on the roster the school turns in. Division I Manual, Bylaws 17.2.1 and 17.2.2.

What nobody has printed. A settlement school is one in a defendant conference, or one that opted in. There is no published list of the schools outside those conferences that opted in. A school that did not opt in does not have to follow the 28 limit. The school or its conference may set its own roster size. If it gives more aid than the old 14, the settlement rules apply, and so does the 28 limit.

The warning. One recruiting site prints that Division I programs may now "offer 28 scholarships." That site is describing a roster limit, not a budget. Ask each school two things. Did it opt in for the year she would enroll? Schools choose each year. And how many of its players get athletics aid?

Read 11 November 2026. The College Sports Commission table of old scholarship limits and new roster limits lists women's soccer at 14 and 28. Division I Manual 2026-27, Bylaw 17.2 and Bylaw 15. The NCAA settlement question-and-answer, updated 29 May 2026. That last paper was read for this publisher's volleyball book and checked again on 11 November 2026.

EVERY LEVEL, SIDE BY SIDE

LEVEL	THE RULE IN 2026-27	TEAMS	AVERAGE SQUAD	WHERE IT IS WRITTEN
DIVISION I, SETTLEMENT SCHOOL	A roster limit of 28. No NCAA aid cap. In place since 1 July 2025.	349 in all of Division I	32.1	Division I Manual, Bylaw 17.2. College Sports Commission table.
DIVISION I, NOT OPTED IN	It does not have to follow the 28 limit. The school or its conference may set its own roster size. If it gives more aid than the old 14, the settlement rules apply, and so does the 28 limit.	inside the 349	inside the 32.1	NCAA settlement question-and-answer, updated 29 May 2026.
DIVISION II	9.9 equivalencies per team each year. No national roster limit.	261	32.2	Division II Manual, Bylaw 15.4.2.1.2.
DIVISION III	No athletics aid at all. No national roster limit.	416	27.7	Division III Manual, Bylaws 15.01.3 and 15.01.4.
NAIA	An aid ceiling of 12 for soccer. The table prints no unit. It is not a roster limit. The same handbook says: "No limit will be placed on the number of student-athletes on any varsity roster."	no official count	not published	NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027, printed page 123. The roster line is on printed page 121.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	24 letter of intent signees per team. A signee is a player who has signed the college's letter. The number is the same in all three NJCAA divisions.	264	not published	NJCAA Sports Procedures Chart for 2026-27.

The three NCAA team counts are the NCAA's own projected figures for 2026-27, final as of 29 July 2026. Average squads are from the NCAA report for 2024-25. The junior college count is printed on the NJCAA's teams page for 2026-27 and covers its three divisions together. The NJCAA chart is reissued during the year, so check the association's own page for the newest file. All read 11 November 2026.

TWO OFFICIAL COUNTS, AND WHY BOTH ARE PRINTED

The NCAA projects 349 teams in Division I, 261 in Division II and 416 in Division III for 2026-27. That is 1,026 together. Its report for 2024-25 counted 1,029: 341, then 268, then 420. Both are official. One is a projection and one is a year-end count, for two different years. So this book prints both, with their dates.

The same report gives the average squad. In 2024-25 it was 32.1 players in Division I, 32.2 in Division II and 27.7 in Division III. Look at the Division I figure. It is above the new limit of 28. That report year was the last one before the limit.

HOW A PART SCHOLARSHIP COUNTS

- **Division I, settlement school.** A part scholarship counts against no NCAA team total. What counts is the roster spot. Any player who gets athletics aid must be on the roster for the whole school year. The roster is due the day before the first game that counts, or 1 December, whichever comes first. College Sports Commission table.
- **Division II.** The school divides her athletics aid by the value of a full grant, which is a full scholarship. So half a scholarship counts as 0.5 of the 9.9. The rule caps the sum, not the number of players who get aid. Division II Manual, Bylaws 15.4.1 and 15.4.2.2.
- **NAIA.** Two kinds of aid sit outside the 12. Aid to a student the NAIA calls "academically gifted" can be left out, if she meets the NAIA's academic criteria. The NAIA page read for this book prints no grade or score for that, so ask the school what counts. Aid to a player who does not play in varsity games does not count. NAIA financial aid page.
- **Junior college.** In NJCAA Division I the aid may cover tuition, books, fees, room and board, up to $250 in course supplies, and one trip each school year. In NJCAA Division II it stops at tuition, books, fees and the $250. NJCAA Division III gives no athletics aid. NJCAA chart and its page on divisions.
- **One player's ceiling.** No Division I player may get more than the school's cost of attendance. Her aid may go up for any reason at any time. Division I Manual, Bylaws 15.1 and 15.3.5.

WHAT THE ODDS REALLY SAY

In 2024-25, 393,048 girls played high school soccer. That year 31,200 women played NCAA soccer. The NCAA puts the share who reach any NCAA team at 7.9 percent. It puts Division I at 2.8 percent, Division II at 2.2 percent and Division III at 3.0 percent. Each share is rounded, so the three add up to 8.0, not 7.9. NCAA Research table, last updated March 2026.

Read those as a guide, not a promise. The NCAA calls them rough figures, not an exact count. Girls who play only club are not in the high school number. NAIA and junior college spots are not in the college number. Each gap pushes the figure a different way.

WHO ELSE WANTS THOSE SPOTS

College players may give notice that they are leaving in two windows. For Division I women's soccer in 2026-27 they are 23 November to 22 December 2026, and 1 May to 15 May 2027. Spots open and close in those weeks. Ask a coach how many are open after each one. Division I Manual, Figure 13-1.

WHAT IS NOT COUNTED HERE

This book found no official count of NAIA women's soccer programs. One recruiting service prints 195 SERVICE, and that is a company's number, not the NAIA's. The NAIA's 2026 championship roster listed 40 teams. That is the field for one tournament, not a count of programs. The junior college count has no split by division. No official average squad was found for NAIA or junior college. And no club fee or team tournament price is printed anywhere in this book. Chapter 8 says why.

SO HOW LONG SHOULD HER LIST BE?

This is this book's view, not a rule. Build the list across all five levels. Division III has more teams than any other NCAA division. A list made only of Division I names skips most of the map.

3. THE PLAN BY DATE, CLASS OF 2029

She is in 10th grade in 2026-27, so these dates are hers. The NCAA has printed one recruiting calendar so far, for 2026-27. The calendars for her junior and senior years are not out yet. Check each row again inside six months of its date.

WHEN	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT YOUR FAMILY DOES	WHERE IT IS WRITTEN
PROJECTED AND HARD	**How to read the first column.** HARD means a named document prints that date. The last column names the document. PROJECTED means this book worked the date out from rule text. Nobody has printed it yet, so it can move. A row whose rule sets no date is tagged PROJECTED and says so.		
1-11 AUG 2026 HARD	Dead period one of four, 1 to 11 August. It is past, but it shows what next August may look like.	Note that the first open day was 12 August. Plan next summer with that in mind.	Division I recruiting calendar for 2026-27, updated 4 August 2026.
1 NOV 2026 HARD	The junior college signing date for soccer. A two-year school may not sign a recruit before it.	Nothing yet. Her own date is two years off, and no chart prints it.	NJCAA Sports Procedures Chart for 2026-27.
9-12 NOV 2026 HARD	Dead period two, 9 to 12 November. It runs Monday to Thursday of signing week. The first signing day for soccer this year is 11 November 2026.	Nothing to sign yet. Learn the pattern. Her own signing week comes in two years.	The same calendar. NCAA signing dates sheet for 2026-27.
23 NOV TO 22 DEC 2026 HARD	The fall transfer window for Division I women's soccer. College players may give notice that they are leaving.	Roster spots open and close now. In January, ask each coach what changed.	Division I Manual 2026-27, Figure 13-1.
16 DEC 2026 TO 6 JAN 2027 HARD	Dead period three, 16 December to 6 January. A Division I coach may not watch a game or host a visit.	Do not buy a holiday showcase to be seen by Division I staff. They may not be there.	Division I recruiting calendar for 2026-27. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.02.5.5.
1 MAY TO 15 MAY 2027 HARD	The spring transfer window for fall sports other than football.	Ask again about open spots at the end of May.	Division I Manual 2026-27, Figure 13-1.
PROJECTED 1 JUN 2027	A junior college may pay for a visit from 1 June before junior year. One paid visit per college each recruiting year, up to 48 hours, for her and two guests.	If a two-year school is on her list, ask about a visit.	NJCAA Bylaws 2026-27, Article VI, Section 4.B.1. NJCAA official visit form, April 2025.
PROJECTED 15 JUN 2027	The first day a Division I coach may call, text or email her, or take her call. The same day, a Division II coach may meet her in person, pay for a visit and hold a tryout. Before this day a Division I coach may only send a short reply that does not recruit her. It can explain the rules or point her to admissions.	Send the email in Chapter 6 that week. Answer each reply within a day.	Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.1.3.2.5, 13.4.1 and 13.4.1.13. Division II Manual, Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2 and 13.8.2.1.
28-31 JUL 2027 HARD	Dead period four, 28 to 31 July. It is printed on the 2026-27 calendar.	Plan no Division I visit or meeting for these four days.	Division I recruiting calendar for 2026-27.

WHEN	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT YOUR FAMILY DOES	WHERE IT IS WRITTEN
PROJECTED 1 AUG 2027	By rule, the first day a Division I coach may meet her off campus, pay for a visit, or host an unofficial visit with the athletics staff. In 2026 this day sat inside a dead period, and the real first day was 12 August.	Do not book travel for early August until the 2027-28 calendar is printed. Phone and text stay open in a dead period.	Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.6.2.1.1 and 13.7.1.1.
11 AUG 2027 HARD	The first day a Division I women's team may play a game in 2027. In 2026 it was 12 August. The 2028 date is 9 August 2028.	College staffs are in their own season from here. Send her fall schedule before it starts.	Division I Manual 2026-27, Figure 17-2.
PROJECTED 1 JAN 2028	A Division III school may pay for a visit from 1 January of junior year. One paid visit per school, up to 48 hours.	Ask her top Division III schools which weekend works.	Division III Manual, Bylaws 13.6.1.1, 13.6.1.1.1 and 13.6.2.
PROJECTED START OF 12TH GRADE	The rule sets no date. Division I wants ten of her 16 core courses done before her seventh semester starts. Seven of the ten must be English, math or science.	Her school sets the day that semester starts. In the spring of junior year, check her classes against the NCAA list with her counselor.	NCAA initial-eligibility brochure. It gives the rule and no calendar day.
PROJECTED 1 AUG 2028	The first day a Division I school may send her an offer of athletics aid in writing, or say in writing that one is coming.	Ask for the amount and the years on paper. Talk is not an offer.	Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.9.3.1.
PROJECTED 8 NOV 2028	The first day she may sign, at 7 a.m. The rule is the second Wednesday in November. The NCAA has not printed a signing sheet for 2028-29.	Read the offer before the day. Chapter 7 lists what to check.	Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f). Division II Manual, Bylaw 13.02.10.1(c).
PROJECTED SUMMER 2029	The rule sets no date for her year yet. A Division I women's team may start preseason 14 days before its first game date. A 14-day transition period may come before preseason. It is lighter training, capped at ten hours a week.	She can be due on campus in mid to late July. Plan for a short summer before college.	Division I Manual, Bylaws 17.22.2 to 17.22.6. Figure 17-2 prints first game dates only through 2028.

Nothing else is printed for this sport. The calendar lists four dead periods for women's soccer and no other kind of period. It prints no quiet period, no evaluation period and no recruiting shutdown. So in 2026-27 a Division I coach may watch and meet recruits from 12 August to 15 December, except 9 to 12 November, and again from 7 January to 27 July. The limit of seven chances in Chapter 4 still applies. The calendar gives a reason for the November dates only.

TWO THINGS THESE DATES DO TO YOUR MONEY

The August trip. Many guides say visits open on 1 August of junior year. For women's soccer in 2026 that day was inside the 1 to 11 August dead period. The first day a Division I coach could meet a girl in person was 12 August. Phone and text stayed open the whole time. Do not pay for flights until the new calendar is out.

The holiday showcase. From 16 December to 6 January a Division I coach cannot watch or host. So holiday showcases in that window go largely unwatched by Division I staff. If the goal is Division I eyes, that entry fee and that hotel bill buy very little.

Eight rows are tagged PROJECTED. Six take a rule's date and apply it to a girl who ends 10th grade in spring 2027. Two rest on rules that set no date, and those rows say so. Neither the NCAA nor the NJCAA has printed any of the eight. Check them against the 2027-28 calendar and the 2028-29 signing sheet when those come out. Every document here was read 11 November 2026.

4. WHAT A COACH MAY AND MAY NOT DO

The rules are written about the coach, not about her. Each level sets its own first days. Women's soccer has no special line in the Division I contact rules. It follows the general rule in each one.

LEVEL	CALLS, TEXTS AND EMAIL	MEETING HER IN PERSON	WHERE IT IS WRITTEN
DIVISION I	From 15 June after sophomore year. Before that day the coach may not take her call, and may only send a short reply that does not recruit her. After it, no rule limits how often a coach calls.	Away from campus, from 1 August of junior year.	Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.1.3.2.5, 13.4.1, 13.4.1.13 and 13.1.1.1.
DIVISION II	At any time. This has been the rule since 1 August 2024.	From 15 June before junior year. One tryout per school is allowed from the same day.	Division II Manual, Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.1.1.1 and 13.8.2.1.
DIVISION III	No limit on timing. Messages must be private.	Away from campus, once she has finished sophomore year.	Division III Manual, Bylaws 13.02.10, 13.02.10.1 and 13.1.1.1.
NAIA	All year. No limit on how many, or what kind.	No recruiting calendar at all.	NAIA recruiting page and NAIA parents page.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	Not settled. See Chapter 11.	A paid visit from 1 June before junior year.	NJCAA Bylaws 2026-27, Article VI, Section 4.B.1.

All read 11 November 2026, in the 2026-27 manuals and on the NAIA's own pages.

DIVISION I: SEVEN CHANCES A YEAR

Each Division I school gets seven recruiting chances with her each year. A chance is a contact or an evaluation. A contact is a face-to-face talk. An evaluation is a coach watching her play or checking her grades. From 1 August of junior year, no more than three off-campus contacts may be among the seven. A talk with a parent counts as a contact. Talks during a campus visit do not count. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.1.5.1.

AT A TOURNAMENT

A Division I coach may not talk with her in person before she plays on a game day. The coach may talk with her once her games are done for the day and her own coach lets her go. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.1.6.2.1. Division III works the same way, and its coaches may not message her at the field. Division III Manual, Bylaw 13.1.3.1.

WHAT A DEAD PERIOD STOPS, AND WHAT IT DOES NOT

In a dead period a Division I coach may not meet her or watch her, on campus or off. No visit of either kind may happen. The coach may still call, text and email. The four dead periods for women's soccer in 2026-27 are 1 to 11 August, 9 to 12 November, 16 December to 6 January, and 28 to 31 July. A dead period stops for her at one school in two cases. She has signed that school's offer of a place or of aid. Or she has paid her deposit there. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.02.5.5 and 13.02.5.5.1.

Division II has one dead period for soccer. It is the 48 hours before 7 a.m. on signing day. The words "dead period" do not appear in the Division III recruiting rules at all. Division II Manual, Bylaw 13.02.10. Division III Manual, Bylaw 13.

A DIVISION I VISIT: WHO PAYS FOR WHAT

ITEM	OFFICIAL VISIT: THE SCHOOL PAYS	UNOFFICIAL VISIT: THE FAMILY PAYS	BYLAW
FIRST DAY	1 August of junior year.	Any time on her own. With the athletics staff, 1 August of junior year.	13.6.2.1.1 and 13.7.1.1
HOW MANY	One paid visit per school. No cap on the number of schools.	No limit.	13.6.2.2 and 13.7.2
HOW LONG	No more than two consecutive nights of lodging.	The school pays for no lodging.	13.6.4 and 13.7.3.1
TRAVEL	Her trip, plus the round trip for up to two family members.	The family pays.	13.5.2.1 and 13.5.2.6
LODGING AND MEALS	For her and up to four family members, within 30 miles of campus. Up to three meals a day.	She pays for her meals. A dorm bed costs the normal rate.	13.6.6, 13.6.7.7 and 13.7.3.1
TICKETS	Up to five free tickets to a home game.	Up to three free tickets, and nothing else.	13.6.7.2 and 13.7.3.1
FUN	Up to $60 a person. No cash and no gifts to take home.	None.	13.6.7.4
BEFORE SHE COMES	A transcript, an Eligibility Center account, and her name on the school's request list.	Not listed in the rules this book read.	13.6.3

Division I Manual 2026-27, read 11 November 2026. No visit of either kind may happen in a dead period. The request list is the school's own list of recruits.

TWO VISIT NUMBERS THE WEBSITES GET WRONG

Tickets. One common recruiting site prints three tickets for an official visit. The bylaw says five, and the bylaw wins. Three is the number for an unofficial visit.

The number of visits. Families still hear "five official visits." The 2026-27 manual prints no cap on the number of official visits a player may take. The limit is one paid visit per school. A school may pay for one more after it hires a new head coach. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.6.2.2 and 13.6.2.2.1.

VISITS AT THE OTHER LEVELS

- **Division II.** A paid visit from 15 June before junior year. One per school, up to 48 hours. On an unofficial visit a Division II school may pay for meals. Division II Manual, Bylaws 13.3.1.1, 13.3.1.2, 13.3.3 and 13.4.2.1.1 to 13.4.2.1.3.
- **Division III.** A paid visit from 1 January of junior year. One per school, up to 48 hours. On an unofficial visit the school may give one meal in its dining hall. Division III Manual, Bylaws 13.6.1.1.1, 13.6.2 and 13.7.2.1 to 13.7.2.1.2.
- **NAIA.** Tryouts are allowed, and the school may give lodging and meals. Two NAIA pages do not agree on the limit. One says two tryout days at each school. The other, from May 2026, says two days in her whole career. Ask the school which it follows.
- **Junior college.** One paid visit per college each recruiting year, up to 48 hours, for her and two guests. NJCAA Bylaws 2026-27, Article VI, Section 4.B.1.

THREE MORE LINES WORTH KNOWING

- She may tour any campus at any age on her own. In Division I the athletics staff may not take part before 1 August of junior year. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.7.1.1.
- A booster is a fan or donor who backs the team. A Division II booster may not contact her before 15 June before junior year. Division II Manual, Bylaw 13.1.3.1.1.
- Once she has joined one NAIA school, coaches at other NAIA schools may not contact her first. This holds even before her classes start. NAIA guide for the college-bound student.

5. CLUB, CAMPS, AND WHERE SHE IS SEEN

A coach can only rate a player the coach has watched. So the first question is not which event is biggest. It is which days a coach is allowed to stand at the field.

THE DAYS A DIVISION I COACH MAY WATCH

In 2026-27 a Division I women's soccer coach may watch and meet recruits from 12 August to 15 December, except 9 to 12 November. Then again from 7 January to 27 July. The four blocks below are closed. Division I recruiting calendar for 2026-27, updated 4 August 2026.

DEAD PERIOD	WHAT IT DOES TO A CLUB SCHEDULE
1 TO 11 AUGUST	Early August events are not watched in person by Division I staff. The first open day was 12 August in 2026.
9 TO 12 NOVEMBER	Four days, Monday to Thursday of signing week.
16 DECEMBER TO 6 JANUARY	Holiday showcases fall here. Division I coaches cannot watch them or host her on campus.
28 TO 31 JULY	The last four days of July are closed too.

Check every event on her club list against those four blocks before you pay for a trip. The other levels work on other rules. Division II has only its 48-hour signing dead period. The Division III recruiting rules have no dead period. The NAIA has no recruiting calendar. So an event that Division I staff must skip is not closed to those coaches by any calendar this book found.

THE HIGH SCHOOL SEASON

Her high school season is set by your state association. This book prints none of those dates. Lay her school dates and her club dates next to the four blocks above. Then you can see which games a Division I coach could attend.

WHERE THE SEATS ARE

DIVISION	TEAMS, 2026-27, PROJECTED	TEAMS, 2024-25, COUNTED	PLAYERS, 2024-25	AVERAGE SQUAD, 2024-25
DIVISION I	349	341	10,931	32.1
DIVISION II	261	268	8,635	32.2
DIVISION III	416	420	11,634	27.7
ALL THREE	1,026	1,029	31,200	30.3

Projected counts: the NCAA's own sponsorship table, final as of 29 July 2026. Counted teams, players and squads: the NCAA participation report for 2024-25. Both read 11 November 2026.

In 2024-25, 393,048 girls played high school soccer and 31,200 women played in the NCAA. The NCAA says 7.9 percent reach an NCAA team and 2.8 percent reach Division I. Its count leaves club teams out. Junior college adds 264 teams in 2026-27, by the NJCAA's own page. The NAIA adds more, but this book found no official NAIA program count.

CAMPS AND TRYOUTS

- **A Division I camp must be open to all.** The school may limit it only by number, age, grade or gender. So a camp flyer in her inbox is not an offer. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.12.1.3.
- **What a camp costs.** One-day college ID camps and clinics ran about $125 to $250. SERVICE An ID camp is one where college coaches come to watch players.
- **What a private showcase costs.** Events with several college staffs ran about $169 to $299. SERVICE One company says it caps its events at six players per coach.
- **Division II tryouts.** A Division II school may hold one tryout with her, on its own campus or field, from 15 June before junior year. Division II Manual, Bylaw 13.8.2.1.
- **NAIA tryouts.** Allowed, with a two-day limit. Chapter 4 explains why that limit has two readings.

Camp prices were printed on listing and sign-up pages on 11 November 2026. They are examples, not a full survey.

SUMMER TEAMS WITH OLDER PLAYERS

Before college she may play on a professional team, as long as she takes no more than her actual and necessary costs. She may also try out with one. Division I Manual, Bylaws 12.2.2.2.1 and 12.2.1.1. One summer league for women says all of its players are amateurs, to protect college eligibility. Chapter 7 draws the line she must not cross.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER DOES NOT COUNT

No club fee or team tournament price is printed here. Tournament entry fees are billed to clubs, and this book found no official public page with a cost per family. It did not collect overnight camp prices. It found no official NAIA program count. And it holds no official figure for how many college players came up through a club.

HOW TO BUILD HER LIST

1. Write down schools at all five levels, not only Division I.
2. For each Division I school, ask the coach if the school opted in to the settlement for the year she would enroll. Schools choose each year.
3. Open each team's roster page. Count the players, then count the ones at her position by class year.
4. Mark which of her events fall on days a coach may watch.
5. Send the email in Chapter 6, with her schedule, before each of those events.

6. WHAT TO SEND, AND WHAT GOOD VIDEO LOOKS LIKE

One short email, from her, with two links. Division II, Division III and NAIA coaches may answer it at any time. Before 15 June after her sophomore year, a Division I coach may only send a short reply that does not recruit her. It can explain the rules or point her to admissions. From that day the coach may answer in full. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.4.1 and 13.4.1.13.

SUBJECT LINE, 67 CHARACTERS, NOT COUNTING SPACES

> 2029 outside back, Anytown South HS, 3.7 GPA, film link and club schedule inside

BODY, ABOUT 180 WORDS, FROM HER OWN MAILBOX

> Coach Aldridge,
>
> My name is Tori Marchetti. I am an outside back in the class of 2029 at Anytown South HS. I also play on a club team, and its schedule is linked below.
>
> I know the rules let you write to me in full from 15 June after my sophomore year.
>
> I am 5'7" and left footed. I started 15 of 17 club games this fall, all at left back. My unweighted GPA is 3.7. I am on track for my 16 core courses. I am registered with the NCAA, and my NCAA ID is 2907140058.
>
> I have two questions. Does the 28-player roster limit apply to your team for the year I would enroll? And how many outside backs will you bring in with the class of 2029?
>
> My film is one link with no login: example.com/tori-video
> My fall and spring schedule: example.com/tori-schedule
>
> I would like to call you. Which time zone are you in, and what time of day suits you? My number is (555) 555-0117. My email is player@example.com.
>
> Thanks for reading my email.
>
> Tori Marchetti

Everything in this sample is invented: the player, the school, the coach, the numbers and the links. Sample emails in this book name no real school, club, league, camp or service.

WHY IT IS WRITTEN THIS WAY

- **She writes it.** It goes out from her own mailbox, in her own words.
- **Class year first.** Every date in the rules hangs on her class year. A coach needs it before anything else.
- **Grades next.** Division I and Division II each ask for 16 core courses. Chapter 7 has the rest.
- **The NCAA ID.** She needs an Eligibility Center account before a Division I school may pay for a visit or send an offer. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.6.3 and 13.9.2.
- **The roster question.** At a settlement school the limit is 28 players. The answer tells her which rule the school expects to be under. Schools choose each year, so she asks again before she enrolls. See Chapter 2.
- **The time zone.** She asks where the coach's clock is. She does not name a place.
- **No phone call to Division I yet.** Before 15 June after sophomore year, a Division I coach may not take her call. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.1.3.2.5.

WHAT GOOD VIDEO LOOKS LIKE

No rule book says what a film must hold. This book read no NCAA, NAIA or NJCAA paper that sets a length or a format. It also holds no survey of soccer coaches on video. So the list below is this book's own view, and nothing more. The best guide is the coach: ask what the staff wants to see.

- Open with her name, class year, position, shirt number and shirt color.
- Put her best clips first.
- Use game film. Show a few seconds before and after her touch.
- Mark her on the screen before each clip starts.
- Keep a full game ready to send when a coach asks.
- Use one link with no login. Test it on a phone that is not signed in.

WHAT A SCHOOL MUST HAVE ON FILE FIRST

BEFORE THIS	THE SCHOOL NEEDS	WHERE IT IS WRITTEN
DIVISION I PAID VISIT	Her transcript, her Eligibility Center account, and her name on the school's request list.	Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.6.3.
DIVISION I OFFER IN WRITING	Her Eligibility Center account, her name on the request list, and her finished eligibility questionnaire.	Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.9.2.
DIVISION II PAID VISIT	Her transcript, her Eligibility Center account, and her name on the request list.	Division II Manual, Bylaw 13.3.2.1.
DIVISION II OFFER IN WRITING	Her transcript.	Division II Manual, Bylaw 13.6.2.

Read 11 November 2026. The request list is the school's own list of recruits. Ask the coach to put her on it before a visit.

7. WHAT THE PAPERWORK REALLY MEANS

Four papers matter: the Eligibility Center account, the list of core courses, the offer of aid, and any contract a club puts in front of her. Each one has a date and a price.

THE ELIGIBILITY CENTER ACCOUNT

ACCOUNT	PRICE	WHAT TO KNOW
NCAA CERTIFICATION	$120 in the United States, $180 from abroad	This is the price on the live sign-up page. An NCAA slide deck from March 2026 prints $110 and $170. Both are official. The live page is the later one.
NCAA ATHLETICS ONLY	$75	From the NCAA sign-up checklist. One outside site, dated October 2026, prints $85. SERVICE
NCAA PROFILE PAGE	Free	The lightest of the three accounts. From the same NCAA checklist.
NAIA	$110 for a United States or Canadian high school student, $170 from abroad	From the NAIA guide of May 2026. Every NAIA player signs up with the NAIA Eligibility Center.

She needs the NCAA certification account for three things: a Division I official visit, signing for athletics aid, and playing at a Division I or Division II school. Fee waivers exist for families who qualify. The fee cannot be refunded after 30 days. The NCAA does not start her file until a school asks for it. Most Division III players are cleared by their own campus instead.

Read 11 November 2026: the NCAA sign-up page, the initial-eligibility brochure, the guide for the college-bound student-athlete for 2026-27, and the high school counselor guide for 2026-27. The NAIA fee was found the same day for this publisher's men's soccer book and was not opened again here.

THE CLASSES

Division I and Division II each ask for 16 core courses. Division I adds two timing rules. She must finish all 16 in eight semesters, counted from the start of ninth grade. And ten of them must be done before her seventh semester, with seven of the ten in English, math or science. Division I also asks for a core-course grade average of at least 2.3. NCAA initial-eligibility brochure, and the NCAA slide deck of March 2026.

Division II asks for a core-course grade average of at least 2.2. NCAA Guide for the College-Bound Student-Athlete 2026-27, page 16. Ask her counselor to check her classes against the NCAA's list each spring.

THE OFFER, AND THE DAY SHE SIGNS

- **The paper.** The National Letter of Intent is gone from the NCAA rules. What she signs is the school's written offer of athletics aid. The NCAA also calls it an athletics aid agreement. A school may not use any other letter or signing date. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.02.13 and 13.9.3.
- **The first day.** Soccer signs from 7 a.m. on the second Wednesday in November. This year the NCAA printed 11 November 2026. There is one signing period, and no February date for soccer. Each school sets its own last day. NCAA signing dates sheet for 2026-27.
- **The offer cannot come early.** Before 1 August of senior year a Division I school may not send the offer. It may not even say in writing that one is coming. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.9.3.1.
- **Division III.** There is no aid agreement. A school may give her a signing form to celebrate once she is accepted. It does not bind her, and staff may not be there when she signs. Division III Manual, Bylaw 13.9.1.1.
- **NAIA.** There is no national letter and no signing date. She may sign a letter with one school, but it does not make her attend. Some NAIA conferences honor letters signed inside the conference. NAIA parents page.
- **Junior college.** The letter of intent may be signed from 1 November. It lasts one school year, 1 August to 31 July. From the 2027-28 signing date, paper letters are no longer taken. NJCAA chart and NJCAA compliance page.

All read 11 November 2026. Signing dates do not apply to players who transfer from another four-year school.

WHAT THE OFFER CAN HOLD

In Division I her aid may not go above the school's cost of attendance. It may go up for any reason at any time. At a settlement school the offer may come with a second paper about settlement benefits. In Division II her aid is one slice of the team's 9.9. In the NAIA one player's aid stops at cost of attendance too. Division I Manual, Bylaws 15.1, 15.3.5 and 13.02.13.

THE LINE SHE MUST NOT CROSS WITH A CLUB

A professional team is one that pays any player more than actual and necessary costs, or that calls itself professional. Before college she may play on such a team and try out for it. She must take no more than those costs. Division I Manual, Bylaws 12.02.7, 12.2.2.2.1 and 12.2.1.1.

What ends it is a deal to play for pay. That holds if it is only spoken. It holds if she signs and the club never does. Division I Manual, Bylaws 12.2.4 and 12.2.4.2.

Two official texts differ on tryouts. The bylaw sets no time limit. The NCAA's own recruiting page says a team may pay for one tryout, and that it cannot run past 48 hours. Both are printed here. Ask the school's compliance office, the staff who check the rules, which one it applies.

THREE NEWER RULES

- **The clock.** Division I gives five years to play. The clock starts when she first enrolls full time at any college, here or abroad. If she waits, it starts with the school year after her 19th birthday. A gap year spent playing does not stop it. Division I Manual, Bylaws 12.6 and 12.6.1.
- **Agents.** New in 2026: a recruit may have an agent to market her to professional teams. This covers players who first enroll on or after 1 August 2026. Division I Manual, Bylaw 12.3.1.
- **Prize money.** Before college she may take prize money based on how she placed. Only the event's sponsor may pay it. Division I Manual, Bylaw 12.1.2.4.1.

ASK THESE IN WRITING

- Did your school opt in to the settlement for the year I would enroll? Schools choose each year.
- Is the team under the 28-player limit? How many names will be on the roster you turn in?
- How much athletics aid is in the offer, in dollars, and for which years?
- Am I on your school's request list?
- What is the last day your school will take a signed offer?

8. WHAT IT COSTS, AND WHAT IS WASTED

This chapter prints only prices it can point to. Some come from rule books. Some come from companies, and those carry the SERVICE tag. The club season itself has no price here, and the chapter says why.

WHAT	PRICE	WHO PRINTED IT
NCAA CERTIFICATION ACCOUNT	$120, or $180 from abroad	The NCAA's live sign-up page. An NCAA slide deck from March 2026 says $110 and $170.
NCAA ATHLETICS-ONLY ACCOUNT	$75	The NCAA sign-up checklist.
NCAA PROFILE PAGE	Free	The same checklist.
NAIA ELIGIBILITY CENTER	$110, or $170 from abroad	The NAIA guide of May 2026.
ONE-DAY COLLEGE ID CAMP	About $125 to $250 SERVICE	Camp listing pages. Examples, not a full survey.
PRIVATE SHOWCASE	About $169 to $299 SERVICE	The companies' own sign-up pages. Several college staffs attend.
OFFICIAL VISIT	The school pays	Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.5.2.1, 13.5.2.6 and 13.6.6.
UNOFFICIAL VISIT	The family pays	Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.7.2.
CLUB SEASON AND TRAVEL	Not found	See the box below.

All read 11 November 2026. Fee waivers exist for the NCAA account. The fee cannot be refunded after 30 days.

WHAT A SCHOOL MAY PAY, SO YOU DO NOT PAY TWICE

- **Division I official visit.** Her travel, and the round trip for up to two family members. Lodging and meals for her and up to four family members. Five tickets to a home game. Up to $60 a person for fun.
- **Division I unofficial visit.** Three tickets to a home game, and nothing else. One more thing is allowed: a free meal at an open house for all future students, if the school gives it to everyone.
- **Division II unofficial visit.** The school may pay the cost of meals for her and those with her.
- **NAIA tryout.** The school may give lodging and meals.
- **Junior college visit.** If the school spends any money on the visit, it counts as her one paid visit there that year.

Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.5.2.1, 13.5.2.6, 13.6.6, 13.6.7.2, 13.6.7.4, 13.7.3.1 and 13.7.3.1.2.2. Division II Manual, Bylaws 13.4.2.1.1 to 13.4.2.1.3. NAIA recruiting page. NJCAA official visit form, April 2025.

SIX WAYS THE MONEY GETS WASTED

1. **A holiday showcase, bought for Division I eyes.** From 16 December to 6 January a Division I coach may not watch. Those events go largely unwatched by Division I staff.
2. **Flights for 1 August.** In 2026 that day sat in a dead period. The first open day was 12 August. Wait for the new calendar before you book.
3. **A trip in the last days of July.** The calendar closes 28 to 31 July as well.
4. **A camp at a school that is not on her list.** A Division I camp must be open to all. An invite does not show that the staff wants her.
5. **A service that sells "28 scholarships."** The 28 is a roster limit. No school has to fund one spot of it.
6. **A fee the family could have skipped.** Ask about the fee waiver first. And the Profile Page is free.

WHAT THIS BOOK COULD NOT PRICE

No club fee or team tournament price is printed in this book. Tournament entry fees are billed to clubs, not to families. This book found no official public page that gives a cost per family. It did not collect overnight camp prices either. Ask her club for last year's full bill, with travel, before the season starts. That number is the one to plan around.

WHAT AN OFFER IS WORTH

No rule sets a dollar figure. In Division I one player's aid may reach the school's cost of attendance and no higher. In Division II it is a slice of 9.9 for the whole team. In the NAIA the team's aid ceiling for soccer is 12. That is a ceiling on aid, not on players. The same handbook says: "No limit will be placed on the number of student-athletes on any varsity roster." NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027, printed pages 123 and 121. Division III gives none for sport. So ask every school for the amount in dollars, on paper.

9. CHECKLIST BY GRADE

One list for each year. A class of 2029 player is in 10th grade now, so start there and look back at 9th for anything missed. Dates marked PROJECTED come from Chapter 3.

9TH GRADE

- Start counting her 16 core courses. Division I gives eight semesters from the start of ninth grade.
- Open the free Profile Page with the NCAA.
- Put the four dead periods on the family calendar.
- Know who may write to her now. Division II, Division III and NAIA coaches may. A Division I coach may not.
- Start a list of schools at all five levels.

10TH GRADE

- Note 15 June 2027, PROJECTED. It is the first day a Division I coach may call, text or email her. Before that day the coach may only send a short reply that does not recruit her. It can explain the rules or point her to admissions.
- Do not phone a Division I coach before that day. The coach may not take the call.
- Write the email in Chapter 6 and build her film.
- Skip any holiday showcase bought only for Division I eyes. The dead period runs 16 December to 6 January.
- Move up to the NCAA certification account before her first Division I paid visit.
- Note 1 June 2027, PROJECTED. A junior college may pay for a visit from that day.
- Ask her club for last year's full bill before the next season starts.

11TH GRADE

- Note 1 August 2027, PROJECTED. By rule it is the first day for Division I visits and meetings away from campus. Check the new calendar before booking.
- Before a paid visit, send her transcript and ask to be put on the school's request list.
- Take one paid visit per school. There is no cap on the number of schools.
- Ask each Division I school if it opted in to the settlement for the year she would enroll. Schools choose each year.
- Note 1 January 2028, PROJECTED. Division III schools may pay for a visit from that day.
- Have ten core courses done before her seventh semester starts.
- Ask each coach how many roster spots moved after the transfer windows.

12TH GRADE

- Note 1 August 2028, PROJECTED. A Division I school may send the offer in writing from that day.
- Fill in the eligibility questionnaire before a Division I offer can be sent.
- Note 8 November 2028, PROJECTED. It is the first day she may sign, from 7 a.m.
- Read the offer before that day: the dollars, the years, and the last day to sign.
- Ask the NCAA for her final athletics certification. That request opens in senior year.
- For Division III, know that the signing form is a keepsake. It does not bind her.
- For junior college, the letter of intent may be signed from 1 November.
- Plan a short summer. A Division I player can be due on campus in mid to late July.

EVERY YEAR, THE SAME THREE CHECKS

Check her classes against the NCAA's core-course list with her counselor. Check her club and school dates against the dead periods. And check this book's PROJECTED dates against the newest NCAA calendar and signing sheet. Her high school dates come from your state association.

Rules behind this page are in Chapters 3, 4 and 7, each with its bylaw. All read 11 November 2026.

10. TEN WAYS FAMILIES GET SOCCER WRONG

Each line below is something families repeat. Each answer names the rule or the document that says otherwise. The last one has a real answer that most other sports do not have.

1. "**She can call the coach any time, and the coach can pick up.**" Not in Division I. Staff may not take her call before 15 June after sophomore year. Before 15 June a Division I coach may only send a short reply that does not recruit her. It can explain the rules or point her to admissions. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.1.3.2.5 and 13.4.1.13.
2. "**She gets five official visits, with three tickets each.**" Both numbers are off. The 2026-27 manual has no cap on her total visits, only one paid visit per school. And an official visit comes with up to five tickets. Division I Manual, Bylaws 13.6.2.2 and 13.6.7.2.
3. "**Visits open on 1 August before junior year.**" By rule, yes. But in 2026 that day sat in a dead period for women's soccer. The first open day was 12 August. Division I recruiting calendar for 2026-27.
4. "**The holiday showcase is where Division I coaches shop.**" From 16 December to 6 January they may not watch or host at all. The same calendar.
5. "**Division I has 28 scholarships now.**" It has a roster limit of 28 at settlement schools, with no aid cap and no duty to fund a spot. Before 1 July 2025 the limit was 14 equivalencies. The 28 is in Division I Manual, Bylaw 17.2. The old 14 is in the College Sports Commission table.
6. "**Soccer signs the National Letter of Intent in February.**" That letter is gone. Soccer signs an aid agreement from the second Wednesday in November. NCAA signing dates sheet for 2026-27.
7. "**Division II coaches can start calling on 15 June.**" They may call, text or email at any time, and have since 1 August 2024. The 15 June date is for meeting in person, paid visits and tryouts. Division II Manual, Bylaws 13.1.3.1 and 13.1.1.1.
8. "**She can tour campus at any age.**" Only without the athletics staff. In Division I a visit with the athletics staff may not happen before 1 August of junior year. Division I Manual, Bylaw 13.7.1.1.
9. "**Playing with pros ends her eligibility.**" Not by itself. Before college she may play on a professional team if she takes no more than actual and necessary costs. Signing to play for pay is what ends it. Division I Manual, Bylaws 12.2.2.2.1 and 12.2.4.
10. "**There is no real job in soccer after college.**" There is one, and its pay is in print. See below.

THE PRO ANSWER: THE NATIONAL WOMEN'S SOCCER LEAGUE

The league and its players signed a labor contract that runs through 2030. It was announced on 22 August 2024. Its cover page and Article 2 give its term as 30 July 2024 to 31 December 2030. Section 8.1 sets the lowest base salary a team may pay, year by year.

SEASON	LOWEST BASE SALARY
2026	$50,500
2027	$65,000
2028	$67,600
2029	$70,500
2030	$82,500

Collective Bargaining Agreement 2024-2030, Section 8.1, page 22 of the PDF file (printed page 15), in the public copy posted by the players association. Read 11 November 2026.

- **Rosters hold 22 to 26 players in 2026.** From the 2027 season the low end is 23. Labor contract, Article 15, Section 15.1.
- **The draft was abolished.** A draft is teams taking turns to pick new players. The league ended its entry draft before the 2025 season. The contract ends the expansion draft too. A college player now picks her club and deals with it herself. Sections 13.8 and 13.9.
- **A contract signed before she turns 18 runs at most three years.** That count includes option years, which are extra years written into the deal. For players 18 and older the limit is five. Labor contract, Section 13.7.
- **A team that brings in a girl under 18 as a trialist or an amateur player must give a safety plan.** It covers housing, rides, school, adult care, health and her growth as a player. A trialist is a player on a tryout. Article 7A.
- **School costs for a player who signed before 18.** The team may pay college tuition of up to $10,000 a year, through the year she turns 22. Side letter on school costs.
- **A girl of 17 or younger comes in by her own route.** She and a parent must both agree. One league paper limits a team to four such players. The league's 2023 release said two. Both are printed here, and Chapter 11 says what was not read.
- **There is no top pay for one player.** The league said so in its release of 22 August 2024.
- **The cost in college terms.** A league contract pays a salary. So it ends her NCAA eligibility in soccer. Division I Manual, Bylaws 12.2.4 and 12.02.7.

OTHER ROADS AFTER HIGH SCHOOL

A second top-level women's league began play in August 2024. It lists eight clubs for its fall 2026 season. This book found no printed pay floor or roster size for it. Moving abroad young is hard: world soccer's rules allow a move between countries only for players over 18, with five listed exceptions. Those rules also cap a contract for a player under 18 at three years. And the NCAA no longer prints the odds of going pro in this sport, because the leagues ended their drafts.

Read 11 November 2026. The second league's own pages. The FIFA Regulations on the Status and Transfer of Players, Article 19. The NCAA's page on the odds of playing past high school.

11. SOURCES, AND WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE

Every rule, number and date in this book came from one of the documents below, read on 11 November 2026. Where two official pages disagree, both figures are printed in the chapter that uses them.

NCAA Division I Manual 2026-27, pages dated 11/11/26, read in full text. Used for Bylaws 12, 13, 15 and 17, Figure 13-1 for the transfer windows and Figure 17-2 for the first game dates. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

NCAA Division II Manual 2026-27, pages dated 11/11/26, read in full text. Used for Bylaws 13 and 15. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90010

NCAA Division III Manual 2026-27, pages dated 11/11/26, read in full text. Used for Bylaws 13 and 15. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90011

"2026-27 NCAA Recruiting Calendar, Other Division I Sports," marked "Updated: August 4, 2026." Used for the four women's soccer dead periods and the men's soccer periods. Read as text and as an image. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/compliance/recruiting/calendar/2026-27/2026%E2%80%9327D1Rec_OtherRecruitingCalendar.pdf

"2026-27 NCAA Signing Dates," for 11 November 2026 and the line that final dates follow each school's policy. athleticsaid.s3.amazonaws.com/2026-27DI_SigningDates.pdf

College Sports Commission, "Old Scholarship Limits and New Roster Limits," for women's soccer at 14 and 28, the roster rules and the roster due date. collegesportscommission.org/roster-limits

NCAA settlement question-and-answer, updated 29 May 2026, items A11, A16 and C3, for schools that did not opt in. Read for this publisher's volleyball book, and checked again on 11 November 2026. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/governance/d1/legislation/May2026D1Gov_PhaseEightSetQuestionandAnswer.pdf

NCAA page on Division II athletics scholarships, for 9.9 and the part-scholarship model. ncaa.org/division-ii/governance/membership-and-institutional-resources/athletics-scholarships

NCAA composition and sport sponsorship table, projected 2026-27, final as of 29 July 2026, for 349, 261 and 416 teams, 1,026 together. ncaa.org/sports/2013/11/20/composition-and-sport-sponsorship-of-the-ncaa-membership.aspx

NCAA Sports Sponsorship and Participation Rates Report, 2024-25 data, page 94, for 341, 268 and 420 teams, 1,029 together, the player counts and the average squads. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/research/sportpart/2025RES_SportsSponsorshipParticipationRatesReport.pdf

NCAA Research, estimated probability of competing in college athletics, table last updated March 2026, for 393,048, 31,200, 7.9 percent, 2.8 percent, 2.2 percent and 3.0 percent, and the men's 5.9 percent. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/research/pro_beyond/RES_ProbabilityBeyondHSFiguresMethod.pdf and ncaa.org/student-athletes/probability-of-competing-beyond-high-school

NCAA Eligibility Center: the live sign-up page for $120 and $180; a slide deck dated March 2026 for $110, $170 and the 2.3 floor; the sign-up checklist for $75 and the free Profile Page; the initial-eligibility brochure; the guide for the college-bound student-athlete 2026-27, with the 2.2 Division II floor on page 16; and the high school counselor guide 2026-27. The brochures and guides were read as excerpts, not whole. web3.ncaa.org/ecwr3/register/CERTIFICATION and fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center

NCAA recruiting page, for the tryout wording that differs from Bylaw 12.2.1.1. Read as an excerpt. ncaa.org/eligibility-center/recruiting

NAIA Official Handbook 2026-2027, 41st edition, printed page 123, which is page 124 of the PDF file, for the aid ceiling of 12 in soccer. Printed page 121 of the same handbook, for the line that no limit is placed on a varsity roster. Checked 11 November 2026. An hour later the address sat behind a human check and could not be opened again. naia.org/wp-content/uploads/2026-07-2026_Official_Handbook.pdf

NAIA: the recruiting page, the parents page and the financial aid page, read as excerpts. The NAIA guide of May 2026 for the fees and the career tryout limit; that guide was found for this publisher's men's soccer book the same day and was not opened again here. naia.org/why-naia/recruiting

NAIA women's soccer championship manual for 2026, for the 40-team bracket. naia.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/10/2026-W-Soccer-FSR-Participant-Manual-Final.pdf

NJCAA Sports Procedures Chart for 2026-27, read in full, for 24 signees, the 1 November signing date and what the aid may cover. The chart is reissued during the year, so check the association's own page for the newest file. njcaa.org/compliance

NJCAA Handbook, Bylaws 2026-27, Article VI, read as excerpts, and the NJCAA official visit form of April 2025, for paid visits. The NJCAA compliance page for online signing. The NJCAA women's soccer teams page for 264 teams, read through a search index because the page builds its list by script. njcaa.org/compliance and njcaa.org/stats/wsoc/teams

National Women's Soccer League Collective Bargaining Agreement 2024-2030, public copy posted by the players association, for its cover page and Article 2, Section 8.1, Sections 13.7 to 13.9, Article 7A, Article 15 at Section 15.1 on page 55 of the PDF file (printed page 48), and the side letter on school costs for players under 18. nwslplayers.com/_files/ugd/84dade_0b675d2ffb2048f8b89257555a35f231.pdf

The league's release of 22 August 2024 on the contract, for the day it was announced and for the line that no player's pay has a top. Its paper on players under 18 and its release of 20 March 2023, for the two team limits of four and two. All read as excerpts. nwslsoccer.com/news/nwsl-and-nwslpa-agree-to-historic-collective-bargaining-agreement

The second professional league in Chapter 10 is the USL Super League, now sold under a sponsor's name. Its About page, its question page and its release of 5 June 2026 were read as excerpts. gainbridgesuperleague.com/about

The summer league in Chapter 5 is the USL W League. Its question page says all players are amateurs. Read as an excerpt. uslwleague.com/faqs

FIFA Regulations on the Status and Transfer of Players, edition titled January 2027, Article 19, read as an excerpt. digitalhub.fifa.com/asset/e495d04b-ef95-4d07-ace2-ea4d7781d7de/Regulations-on-the-Status-and-Transfer-of-Players_January-2027.pdf

Camp and showcase prices, all tagged SERVICE, are examples from four listing and sign-up sites, read as excerpts. They are used here as a price band and not as a shortlist of camps. collegeidsignal.com/camps, idcampradar.com/camps, idsportsusa.com and ussportscamps.com

The recruiting site quoted on "28 scholarships," on three tickets and on 195 NAIA teams is NCSA. It is printed here as a company's page, tagged SERVICE. ncsasports.org/womens-soccer/scholarships and ncsasports.org/ncaa-eligibility-center/recruiting-rules/official-visits

The $85 account price is from an outside blog dated October 2026, tagged SERVICE. A College Board counselor page is named below for test scores only. nextcommit.ai/blog/ncaa-eligibility-requirements and counselors.collegeboard.org

WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE

- **Which schools opted in.** No list was found from the NCAA or the College Sports Commission of the schools outside the defendant conferences that opted in for 2026-27. Ask each school.
- **Her own calendars.** The Division I calendars for 2027-28 and 2028-29 are not published. So the exact dead periods for her junior and senior years are not known. The calendar also prints no rule for three of its four dead periods.
- **Her own signing date.** The 8 November 2028 date is this book's sum from the second-Wednesday rule. No 2028-29 signing sheet exists yet.
- **How many NAIA teams there are.** No official count by sport was found. No official average squad was found for NAIA or junior college, and no split of the 264 junior college teams by division.
- **The NAIA tryout limit.** Two NAIA pages disagree: two days at each school, or two days in a career. NAIA rules on who pays for a visit outside a tryout were not found.
- **The NAIA's academic criteria.** The NAIA page says aid to an "academically gifted" student can sit outside the 12. It prints no grade or score for that.
- **Junior college first contact.** No NJCAA rule on the first day for calls, texts or email was found in the text read. Outside guides say a recruit must finish junior year before she signs. That bylaw was not found either.
- **Test scores.** A College Board page still shows a scale of grades and test scores. The NCAA brochure text read for this book lists classes, timing and grades only. This was not settled.
- **Verbal offers.** A search of Division I Bylaw 13 found no rule that names them.
- **Division II and Division III.** No soccer recruiting calendar was found for Division II. The rules on playing for pay were read for Division I only.
- **How many players come from junior college.** The NCAA prints it by sport on a page this book did not open. That is why no such figure is in this book.
- **Club and showcase costs.** No cost per family was found on an official public page. Overnight camp prices were not collected. No official figure was found for how many college players came through a club.
- **Video.** No rule book and no coach survey read for this book sets a standard for film. The list in Chapter 6 is this book's own view.
- **The pro league's fine print.** The league's papers give two limits for players under 18 on one team, four and two. The 2026 rules for those players were not read.
- **Other pro leagues.** No pay floor or roster size was found for the second league. Its own pages disagree on its calendar. A third league has start years of 2026, 2027 and 2028 in print. Pay in leagues abroad was not looked up.
- **Teams added since 1972.** No count with a 1972 start was found, so none is printed.

Made by The Commit Book. Education, not legal advice. No result, no playing time, no acceptance, and no money is promised. Rule text, calendars, counts and price pages checked 11 November 2026. The player, school, coach, numbers and links in the sample email are invented.